Ben Siverly

PRODUCT MANAGER · PAYMENTS & MONEY MOVEMENT

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EXPERIENCE

AppFolio · Product Manager, Rental Applications & Payments

Jan 2023 – Oct 2026

Property-management software for 23,000+ customers. **Sole PM for the rental application line, across two codebases.**

- **Owned checkout for $200M a year in application fees,** built on AppFolio's internal payments API. 70% of applications carry an embedded payment: the applicant pays, the property manager acts on it. Designed an assumed-success window and a tokenized failed-payment recovery path, reaching **99.1% application-payment completion**.
- On the payments team, sized offline rent from accounting receipts and interviewed renters on why they pay offline: irregular gig pay, unbanked renters driving 15–30 minutes for certified funds, 2–3 day ACH. Presented to payments leadership, who **funded teams** to build **rent-split payments with Flex** and a **digital certified-funds partnership**.
- Rebuilt the rental application end to end. Submission rates went from **44% to 70%**, and properties on the new flow fill vacancies **3.4 days faster** than offline workflows. Kept follow-up inside the authenticated app so every interaction stays auditable for screening compliance; customer satisfaction rose **18%**.
- Built a secure applicant-data API and launched it with Zillow. Reached 70% customer adoption, then **pushed to wind it down** when the frictionless path buried property managers in unqualified applicants.

Lively · Data Scientist → Product Manager

Nov 2019 – Dec 2022

HSA platform for tax-advantaged health spending, offered through financial-institution partners.

- **Built the money-movement platform:** bank and card-network transfers, processor integrations, ledgers, and the partner data model. Financial-institution partners could offer compliant HSAs without building their own infrastructure.
- Scoped multi-tenancy with our second partner bank's executives. The move captured **~90 bps more yield on AUM** as rates rose, and opened room for future partners.
- Built partner APIs and migration pipelines that moved **$50M+ in HSA assets** between financial institutions with **zero data loss**. Cut the work from two migration teams to one.
- Stood up the company's first data-science function and data-services platform; promoted to PM in 2021 as the work became the roadmap.

Oracle · Data Scientist, Applied Research

Sep 2017 – Sep 2019

- Rebuilt model validation on a representative U.S. population sample, correcting a skew that distorted model performance. Automated a data pipeline that had taken two analysts full-time.

SELECTED WORK

Brava (bravamade.com). Automated college-recruiting profiles for youth athletes, launching with women's soccer outside major metros. Built with my brother. Sized the market across five sports, ran a COPPA and privacy review for minors' data, and built the AI production pipeline: coach-verified stats, benchmark rankings, generated media. **Payments on Stripe:** a parent checkout flow built from scratch with AI coding agents.

AbiertoClaw (github.com/be-ns/AbiertoClaw). Open-source plugin for the Hermes agent. Each day it finds the best free model that passes a real tool-call test and switches Hermes to it, with a local model as the fallback.

SKILLS

Product: jobs-to-be-done (50–100 customer calls a year), spec-driven development, tests/evals as release gates, OOUX
Payments: checkout, failed-payment recovery, money movement, ledgers, processor integrations, partner APIs
Data: SQL, Python, experimentation, pipelines
AI: RAG, tool use, agents, evals
Writing: Published poet (opol.space, 2026)

EDUCATION

B.A. Communication Studies, Westmont College · Data Science Immersive (ML), Galvanize